

 LASSONDE SCHOOL OF ENGINEERING YORK UNIVERSITÉ UNIVERSITY	Professional Development for COOP Students ePortfolio Tool Instruction Manual COOP 2100
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By Maher Ghalayini, MBA, LLM, Ed.D.

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Overview

This project is worth 50% of your final mark. See the rubric for this project below. A mark of 4 or less will result in an automatic “F” in the course (regardless of your performance on other assignments). If you scored 5-8 on the marking rubric, you have the option of revising and resubmitting your ePortfolio presentation by an agreed upon date with your professor and the completion of appropriate forms.

Failure to satisfy this requirement by the designated date will result in an “F” in the course. You will submit your LP ePortfolio Presentation through the discussion assignment link in week 9 and post the link to your page on the discussion forum to share with yourpeers.

Rubric

Criteria	Excellent- 3 points	Satisfactory- 2.5 points	Development- 2 points	Unsatisfactory- 1 point
	Exceeds Expectations Portfolio reflects evidence of learning integration and cohesiveness.	Meets Expectations	Needs Improvement	Unsatisfactory Portfolio is incomplete in required components or components do not demonstrate learning integration and cohesiveness.
Items/Artifacts Demonstrating Learning Integration and Cohesiveness (Items/Artifacts can include papers (writing), images, audio clips, videos, other documents, etc.)	All artifacts and work samples are clearly and directly related to the purpose of the e-portfolio. Clear evidence of a practical and theoretical understanding related to the disciplines.	Artifacts are of a high quality. Most artifacts and work samples are related to the purpose of the e-portfolio. Artifacts are drawn from a variety of contexts and illustrate the concepts from the fields of study/disciplines.	Artifacts are of poor quality and/or some program competencies are not addressed. No inclusion rationale provided. Artifacts illustrate weak integration and cohesiveness of the fields of study.	Most artifacts and work samples are unrelated to the purpose of the e-portfolio. Student treats each disciplinary area as a separate area/field or some areas of integration are omitted.
Writing/Communication of Achieved Integrated Outcomes (Vocabulary, sentence structure, organization, correct grammar, etc.)	Writing is clear and presents logical and theoretical connections between multiple sections in a cohesive way. There are no errors in grammar, capitalization, punctuation, and spelling. Purpose of the portfolio is clear throughout the portfolio, in terms of philosophy and professional growth.	Writing is clear and organized. There are a few errors in grammar, capitalization, punctuation, and spelling. These require minor editing and revision. Overall, the purpose of the portfolio is clear throughout the portfolio, in terms of philosophy and professional growth..	Writing is unclear and somewhat disorganized. There are 4 or more errors in grammar capitalization, punctuation, and spelling requiring editing and revision. The purpose of the portfolio is somewhat vague and unclear, in terms of philosophy and professional growth.	Writing is unclear and disorganized. There are more than 6 errors in grammar, capitalization, punctuation, and spelling requiring major editing and revision.
Reflection/Critique (Describe professional growth over time in knowledge and skill, linking accomplishments and portfolio artifacts to course, program and personal goals. Reflections include a critique of own work and offers constructive, practical alternatives for continued growth.)	Student reflections/critiques identify and describe professional growth from experiences both inside and outside of the classroom and encompass and display significantly changed perspectives about his/her understanding of complex questions or challenges related to the integration of the discipline areas.	Most of the student reflections/critiques identify and describe professional growth from experiences and learning both inside and outside of the classroom and encompass and display broader perspectives related to the integration of the discipline areas.	Student reflections/critiques reveal some depth, with slightly broader perspectives but are not indicative of critical thought and reflection.	Student reflections/critiques are unclear on professional growth from inside and outside of the classroom, are generally at the surface level without relating to a broader perspective to the items or outcomes for the program. The purpose of the portfolio is missing, in terms of philosophy and professional growth.

Organization/Navigation (How intuitive it is to locate materials in the portfolio, table of contents included to aid in navigation, links to artifacts work, use of relevant items that are grouped coherently.)	The portfolio is very organized and is easy to navigate. The items included are focused on addressing the overall goal of the portfolio to showcase the student work. The document is fully hyperlinked between the index (for table of contents), artifacts and reflections. The index is well organized and easy to navigate.	The portfolio is organized and is somewhat easy to navigate. Most of the items included address the overall goal of the portfolio to showcase the student work. Hyperlinks are organized into logical groups, not all possible features have been employed.	The portfolio is unorganized. Some of the items included relate to the overall goal of the portfolio to showcase the student work. Hyperlinks from the index (or Table of Contents) are linked to the artifacts but lacks organization.	The portfolio is unorganized and difficult to navigate. Items included do not relate to the overall goal of the portfolio to showcase the student work. The index is plain with few if any links. Some links are “broken”.
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Introduction

EPortfolio's provide college students with a space on the Web to organize and store electronic documents of all types. This course will help you learn to assemble and manage personal records, creating a dynamic virtual identity. Students can reflect and comment on their work, and reflect on their growth as they progress, giving it a dynamic journal quality. It is totally controlled by the student, who can come to see the ePortfolio as an enhanced resume, a set of credentials that can grow and stay with them over time.

This manual is intended to assist students in their career development and job search using ePortfolio. ePortfolio is the ideal tool for organizing career goals and keeping track of work related to those goals.

Uses of ePortfolio for Career Services

Placement and Job Search

Good organizational skills and flawless job search documents are critical to an effective job search. ePortfolio allows you to organize your material in a place where they will not be damaged or lost. Moreover, it can be used to showcase your work that can include much more than word processed documents; slide shows, digital art or music, multimedia projects, all types of electronic media can be featured.

Components of ePortfolio (Summary)

1. Index: Can be a side bar, or another form of navigation toolbar.
2. About Me:
 - a. Program: Explain your program of study.
 - b. Goals (general and specific)
 - c. Reflections
 - d. Videos and other multimedia resources
3. Relevant texts
4. Bibliography: Reference any external materials
5. Content result of your (re)search or interests if applicable
6. References and seminars participations (provide evidence) if applicable

Items not to include in your Electronic Portfolio:

Home Address

Work samples containing proprietary or confidential information

Group oriented projects without written permission of co-contributors

Photos of people without permission

Personal information (age, gender, marital status, ethnicity)

Items to include in your Electronic Portfolio:

Your name E-mail address Resume List of courses taken School projects Career summary Functional skills list (EQ, Values, Learning Style)	Course project/paper samples Community involvement Volunteer projects Extra-curricular projects Computer skills Multimedia clips
Type of Projects	Typical Functional Skills
Software design Engineering design Illustrations of computer knowledge Computer-aided design Programming Web site design Hardware & software design/testing System optimization Robotic design Electronic design Thermodynamics Control systems Quality control Multimedia clips	Analytical Project development Problem solving Testing & evaluation Database design Networking Troubleshooting Computer training Project management Presentation Design & implementation Programming Technical writing Statistical analysis

Be thorough and accurate here. Avoid using abbreviations.

A: About Me

You will fill out the “about me” page with a brief biography. The following instructions are suggested, keeping in mind that this is the first page your visitor will see.

- You may provide a link to other webpages if you have one, and may upload a photo. Again, since this will be your “face” to those you invite as guests, be comfortable with any web page they link to, and the photo you choose for them to see.
- You should include Narrative Information on individual pages to explain the different pages, photos etc...
- The content from this page will come from your “About Me” assignment.
- ***Do not enter your date of birth or any other sensitive information in your ePortfolio.***

B. Career: Education, Experience and Resume

The section of ePortfolio called **Career** should document **Education** history, work **Experience** both paid and volunteer and one that includes a formatted **Resume** with your information. It is important to chronicle your development, to establish a baseline of information and reflection on which to build from.

This section will become the definitive chronicle of your school and work, which will grow and mature as you progress in your education and work lives. As you take the time to make **comments** and **reflections** on your progress, you will see the growth over time.

This site can become the reliable career file for you to take from college into your professional life. Good records of education and experience are invaluable when filling out job applications, and when applying for promotions, writing promotional bios, and other uses. The reflections and comments made during or shortly after the experiences can be invaluable later when these thoughts are otherwise forgotten.

Specific instructions for Career sections of ePortfolio:

*The **Biography, Education and Experience** sections are important by themselves even if you are not at the point in your career development that you need a resume. You may use it in the future; resumes are virtually worthless if they have errors, so much emphasis here is on accuracy.*

Enter **Biography** information when first creating the personal ePortfolio. *Care should be taken at the very outset; if this is accurate and typed with proper spelling, punctuation and use of caps etc., it will “flow” into the rest of your site.* Avoid abbreviations, keeping the finished product in mind. One error can contaminate multiple pages.

Education: Include high school diploma, awards, and any prior college degrees, college major and expected date of graduation. “**Degree, Certificate, Honor, Diploma/High School Diploma**”. Training programs and workshops can be entered here as well.

Experience: This should include all paid employment, full time and part time, as well as other experiential accomplishments.

Co-curricular: Activities and accomplishments engaged in while in school which were alongside the curriculum, such as sports, student clubs and groups, arts activities.

Internship: Program-related work experience, normally for credit, either on campus or in the community. Sometimes called “co-op work experience” or “practicum”. Frequently paid work, sometimes unpaid.

Community: Involvement in local community affairs, serving on boards, assisting with community projects or events. This makes a good statement of civic responsibility and would be appropriate on a resume.

Professional: Paid employment. All full and part-time jobs should go here. Even work that does not seem “professional” should be documented here such as pizza delivery, student worker or grocery clerk. This is a wonderful place to make a permanent record of your employment, and maintain it throughout your career.

Some of you may have worked on projects at organizations during your COOP that may have a high level of sensitivity. It is important to ensure that you do not divulge any of this sensitive information (competitive) while explaining what your work was all about.

Research: If engaged in significant research while in college you should keep track of it here. Although the research done for a term paper is not likely to be included on a resume, any project that is beyond that, where professional research skills were learned/used, should be documented here.

Volunteer: Volunteer “jobs” are an important part of growth and professional learning as well as a statement of “giving back”. They often are formative in learning values and attitudes, not to mention transferable skills. Good recording of this important part of your career is essential here.

Responsibilities: document job tasks and responsibilities. These will help while you are building your resume draft, though you may not need them. Good guidance by a resume expert will be valuable here.

Accomplishments: any significant achievements on the job?

Awards: Your work-related awards or commendations can be recorded here.

Skills Used: Identify work-related and transferable skills learned/developed through this experience. This is useful for career planning as you look at skills/abilities you have learned that you will use in other occupations.

Summary: This is useful for making a summary statement about how the job fit into your career.

Other information: Open space to make other comments and personal reflections.

C. Using Goals and Portfolios for Career Planning

The section of ePortfolio called **Goals** and **Portfolios** provide the elements for you to organize your documents or projects and comment on your work.

EPortfolio provides a wonderful way to keep track of your records. You can set personal, educational and career **goals** and put the pieces together to attain those goals in ePortfolio. Each **goal** will contain individual **portfolios** where you can gather the evidence to document your progress and achievements. All your work will be in **portfolios**, organized around your broader **goals**. To make an analogy, this can take a drawer full of scattered, unmarked and yellowed photographs and make clean, well-organized, accurately documented albums that are permanent.

Goals are the broader category, and are a natural way to think about career development. Career goals typically include learning one's interests and skills, choosing a major and a career, and finding an internship or job.

To set up **Goals** for Career Planning:

- o Enter a name for the first **Goal**.
- o For each **Goal**, it is suggested that **Introduction** and **Comments** be entered to summarize what is intended for that part of your ePortfolio. For "About Me" your **Introduction** may be something like: "This is where I am keeping information about who I am." A **Comment** might be "I thought I knew myself, but a better picture of me is emerging here." **Reflection/Learned** allows a place for comments on the career development process and **Other Information** may be important; but are likely added later as you make progress toward your goals.
- o Repeat the process until you have entered in all the career related **goals** for your ePortfolio.

Portfolios are a collection of work that documents or demonstrates the attainment of at least part of the goal. For a creative student this can be the most exciting part of the ePortfolio. Depending on the major, all kinds of projects can be featured -- from spreadsheets for the accounting major, to CAD/D drawings for the engineer, to scanned or digital photos of art work for the art major. All portfolios are connected to goals in ePortfolio. These sections can be placed on a section that is not visible to others externally:

1. Document relevant academic projects related to your major in **Portfolios** created to organize them.
2. Create a **portfolio** called *Decision Making Process* to keep track of materials and reflections related to the important process of finding your career.
3. Create a new **Goal** called *Find a Job*. Set up **Portfolios** called: *Employer Information, Resumes, Cover Letters, Applications and Interviews*.
4. Update resume for COOP applications;

5. Apply for internships. Use *Applications and Interviews* **portfolio** to keep records of activity as needed.
6. Do COOP in major. Document this **Career Experience** so that it can be part of the next resume.
7. Document service learning or semester abroad in **Career: Experience**.
8. Plan summer job that will give relevant experience in chosen field.

To create **Portfolios** related to career planning:

Under the **Goal** called “Discover Myself” you should create **portfolios** like the following:

My Interests and Skills
My Dreams and Goals
My Values and Personality

- o In the **Introduction** box enter a simple description of what you expect the **Portfolio** to contain, if you know this information. For example, “This will contain the results of my Interest Inventory and Skills Identification Checklist”. This could be from your values assessment, Undergraduate competencies, EQ reflection etc...
- o **Reflection, Comments** and **Other Information** can be included for this **portfolio**, or may come later as you enter documents and have comments to add.
- o Repeat for each **Portfolio** you are instructed to enter for your Career Development program.

To add work (documents) to your **portfolio**:

- o Write a brief **introduction** in the appropriate text box. Mention what kind of document it is, and the date you uploaded it.
- o Add some **reflection** on the meaning of this work to your career development. There is room for further **comments** and **other information** that you may be requested to use by your counselor.

Contents of your ePortfolio

It is important to keep in mind that this is “YOUR” ePortfolio. There is no right or wrong, and it will be different for each one of you. It is important to ensure it is a reflection of who you are and your individual accomplishments. Below is a recommendation, and is not a complete compilation of what should be included.

You should first develop the **Career: Education and Experience**, and **build a resume**. The following is an example of how the **Goals** could be organized:

Goal: Discover Myself (self-assessment)

Portfolio: Dreams and Goals

Examples of contents:

Childhood dreams

Why this Major (This comes from your initial post about yourself)

Career Goals

Portfolio: Interests and Skills

Statement(s) about Interests and Passions

Personal Development Goals (Based on your undergraduate Competencies Assessment build SMART goals)

Portfolio: Values and Personality

Personal Philosophy of Learning (From Assignment)

Values Clarification Exercises (Values perspective assessment & Discussion question responses)

EQ (Personality) (reflection from assignment talking about strengths)

Portfolio: Building Credentials

Projects completed (School or Work)

Accomplishments at work (and in community)

Letters of commendation and “thank you” (From work and the community)

III. What Content Should Be in an Electronic Portfolio?

An electronic portfolio should contain professional or career-related content that expands, supports and elaborates on what is found on a resume. Throughout your academic career and employment, collect and preserve documents and items that should be considered for inclusion in an electronic portfolio. Freshmen and sophomore students may want to include items from high school. When compiling an initial portfolio or updating an existing one, review these items and

select a few significant or key pieces that will portray to the reader a brief but high quality overview showcasing your skills, abilities, and accomplishments.

Every portfolio will be different as each person's experiences and backgrounds are unique. Listed below are some suggestions to assist you in determining what items should be considered for inclusion in a portfolio. Also provided are some general guidelines to consider before publishing certain items on the web. Many items are not recommended for publication because of legal and personal safety issues involved in posting them on the web.

Best Practices

➤ Develop a consistent look and feel to your pages.

Since readers of your site will jump around from page to page on the web, you want to develop a look the readers can carry throughout the site. This will accomplish two things. First, the employers should constantly be aware of who you are and one way to accomplish this is by having a constant visual cue such as a logo on every page. Second, lack of consistency presents a scattered, unprofessional image you don't want to broadcast.

➤ Use a table of contents in your homepage.

Design your pages so they are easy to read and use a table of contents at the top so the reader does not have to scroll down the page to locate information. Keep your home page simple; you want to engage the reader on the first page, not confuse them. An easy to read and well-organized home page will entice the reader to explore further. Links should be clearly labeled and descriptive. For example, don't name a link "Class Project." Be specific and label it as "Research Project on Behavior Modification Techniques in the Classroom." Typical headings in a table for contents are: Qualifications Summary, Values, Resume, Academic Coursework, Technical Skills, Work/Project Samples, Interpersonal Skills, Leadership, and Community Involvement. However, headings should be tailored to reflect the skills you are marketing and the field in which you are seeking employment.

➤ Limit the content in your electronic portfolio.

Only post a limited amount of information in your electronic portfolio. Readers will fail to explore all of the links provided if too much content is loaded onto an electronic portfolio. Make sure that your links accurately describe what is contained on those pages so that the reader is able to easily navigate the site and find the information they want to read. Choose your most related and pertinent information that showcases your best work.

Develop a "blank page" which you can be used as a template for the development and format of your web pages. When creating a new page, all you need to do is continually copy and reformat the template. This will help to ensure formatting consistency throughout your electronic portfolio.

➤ Include a home page button and footer with your contact information on every page.

A footer on each web page should include your name, e-mail address, LinkedIn, Google+, Twitter and the date you last updated your site. This eases navigation and provides easy access to your contact information.

➤ **Vary your text styles.**

Just as in a letter or term paper, you may want emphasize key points. Try italics, bolding or even different colored fonts to highlight information and create a site that is pleasing to the reader.

➤ **Keep frames simple.**

Some browsers do not support complex frames, which means your page will not look the same on all browsers. The back button may not take you back and it is harder to print and save desired pages because you have to be active in (or have last clicked in) the frame you wish to print. If you keep it simple, such as a frame for your links and a frame for the body of each page, your design should remain consistent on different browsers. Tables can be used for all the things you want to do in a frame.

➤ **Use thumbnails when you include many photos.**

Shrink your photos down into very small images so that they will not take as much time to download. This saves time when the reader is opening your page. Have the reader click on the picture to bring up the enlarged photos on a separate page. If you're only using one or two pictures, this is not necessary.

➤ **Use graphics, animation and pictures cautiously.**

Graphics provide interest and liven up your site and may be used as links instead of words. However, don't go overboard in their use, as they will take a longer time to download. All animations and graphics do not work in all browsers. If you plan on using them, verify they work in Firefox, Chrome, Explorer & Opera web browsers.

➤ **Test your links at least once a week and continually update your site.**

Sometimes links get lost or damaged. Verify your site and its links are in working order and all of the information on your site is retrievable. Whenever you have any new information pertinent to your job search, update your web site to include it. Readers visiting your site a second time will discover new, additional information about you that makes you more qualified. Also include the date you last updated your site to illustrate you are constantly maintaining your site and the information is correct and up to date.

➤ **Have fun with your electronic portfolio.**

Your web site should not only show your academic side but also your creative and technical side. Don't be afraid to try out different graphics and colors. Feel free to explore some of the sample portfolios listed below or search the web for other sites. Remember to keep your portfolio professional, but having an attractive site will help you to make a positive impression.